8.2.6 Calorimetry

Calorimetry means the measurement of the amount of heat released or absorbed by thermodynamic system during the heating process. When a body at higher temperature is brought in contact with another body at lower temperature, the heat lost by the hot body is equal to the heat gained by the cold body. No heat is allowed to escape to the surroundings. It can be mathematically expressed as

$$Q_{gain} = -Q_{lost}$$

$$Q_{gain} + Q_{lost} = 0$$

Heat gained or lost is measured with a calorimeter. Usually the calorimeter is an insulated container of water as shown in Figure 8.9.

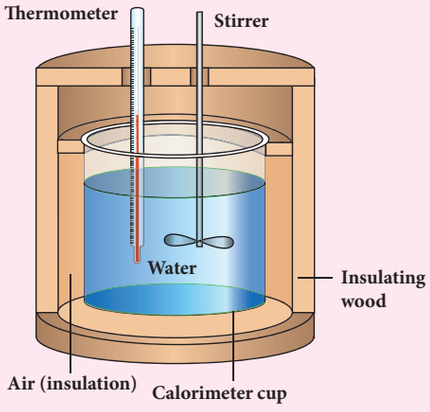


Figure 8.9 Calorimeter

A sample is heated at high temperature (T_1) and immersed into water at room temperature (T_2) in the calorimeter. After some time both sample and water reach a final equilibrium temperature T_f. Since the calorimeter is insulated, heat given by the hot sample is equal to heat gained by the water. It is shown in the Figure 8.10

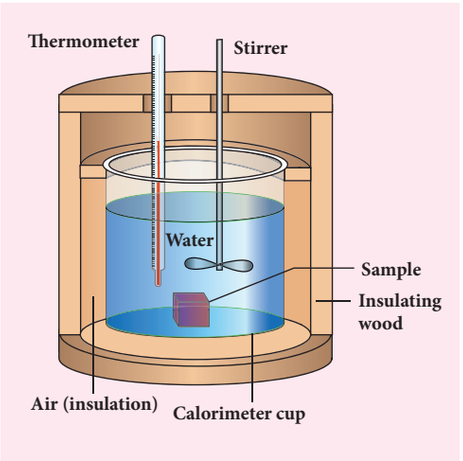


Figure 8.10 Calorimeter with sample of block

$$Q_{gain} = -Q_{lost}$$

Note the sign convention. The heat lost is denoted by negative sign and heat gained is denoted as positive.

From the definition of specific heat capacity

$$Q_{gain} = m_2 s_2 (T_f - T_2)$$

$$Q_{lost} = m_1 s_1 (T_f - T_1)$$

Here s_1 and s_2 specific heat capacity of hot sample and water respectively.

So we can write

$$m_2 s_2 (T_f - T_2) = - m_1 s_1 (T_f - T_1)$$

$$m_2 s_2 T_f - m_2 s_2 T_2 = - m_1 s_1 T_f + m_1 s_1 T_1$$

$$m_2 s_2 T_f + m_1 s_1 T_f = m_2 s_2 T_2 + m_1 s_1 T_1$$

The final temperature

$$T_f = \frac{m_1 s_1 T_1 + m_2 s_2 T_2}{m_1 s_1 + m_2 s_2}$$

EXAMPLE 8.7

If 5 L of water at 50°C is mixed with 4L of water at 30°C, what will be the final temperature of water? Take the specific heat capacity of water as 4184 J kg^{-1} K^{-1}.

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